

Ethan Zaruba-Walker

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EXPERIENCE

StaffRoom AI

Emeryville, CA

Founder & AI Solutions Consultant

October 2023 - Present

- First technical owner on every account: discovery call, scope (data, systems, timeline, out of scope), then a pilot on the customer's own files before a larger build.
- Build the integration myself. Python and TypeScript against REST APIs and webhooks, plus data pipelines. One rebuild raised throughput 99.8% in four months and cut cost 86%.
- Put agentic workflows in front of real users: prompting, tool use, MCP, and an evaluation held to 95% agreement with human reviewers. Claude Code is the daily driver.
- Own deployment through handoff. After go-live I resolve issues, keep the backlog, and train the operator to extend the workflow. Processing time on one pre-sales assessment fell 98%.
- Turn a one-off into a reusable piece: n8n workflows, playbooks, and the next customer's starting point, instead of a fresh script each time.
- Write the requirement an engineer can build from. Discovery notes become a functional spec, not a verbal escalation.
- Sell and deliver the same engagement, up to \$18K. I can tell a non-technical operator and a technical reviewer the same tradeoff in words each of them can use.

IBM

Austin, TX

Data Engineer / Cognitive Software Engineer, Customer Support

August 2018 - December 2020

- Deployed IBMLogAnalyze under a GDPR constraint: client data stayed in a defined pipeline, and 1-3 hours of per-case log prep went to zero. Dashboarded the result for operations leaders.
- Built DRE Bot, a Watson NLP assistant in Slack, after Design Thinking sessions with the engineers who had to trust it. Wrote the release notes for each change.

Valhalla Healthcare

Remote

Machine Learning Engineer (Intern)

May 2021 - August 2021

- Trained a Python model on handwritten clinical notes into a structured schema, F1 80.03.

EDUCATION

University of Colorado Boulder

Boulder, CO

B.S. Information Science; Major GPA 3.7 | Certificate of Cognitive Science; Dean's List

August 2018 - May 2023

IBM

Online

Systems & Solutions Architecture Professional Certificate (in progress)

expected July 2026

DeepLearning.AI

Online

Deep Learning Specialization (Jan 2021) | TensorFlow Developer Certificate (May 2020)

2020 - 2021

SKILLS

Forward deployed: pre-sales discovery, implementation scoping, pilots, API and webhook integrations, data pipelines, handoff, reusable deployment tooling. **Agents:** Python, TypeScript, Claude Code, MCP, prompting, tool use, evaluation.

Data constraint: GDPR-scoped client pipeline at IBM.